Year 12 Admission Assessment

Version 3.1, October 2026

Name	
Date	

Welcome

These activities help us get to know you.

Do your best.

It is fine if you cannot answer every question.

Your teacher will tell you when to start each part.

How to answer

Tick one box.

Which one is a fruit? a chair ☐ an apple ☑ a bus ☐

Write your answer in the box.

12 + 8 = **20**

Show your working. You can get marks for your working, even if your answer is wrong.

Working

4 × 25 = 100, 100 + 30 = 130

The parts of this paper

Part	What you do	Time
Listening	Listen to a conversation and a talk. Answer 16 questions.	15 minutes
Reading	Read two texts. Answer the questions.	15 minutes
Writing	Write a story or an essay.	10 minutes
Break		5 minutes
Maths	Fluency, word questions and applied problems.	25 minutes
Science	Questions with pictures, tables and graphs.	8 minutes
Other parts	In **separate booklets**, after a break: a cognitive ability screen (puzzles), the sciences you will study, and an interview.	later today

You may use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. You may use a calculator **only** in Maths Section C.

Listening

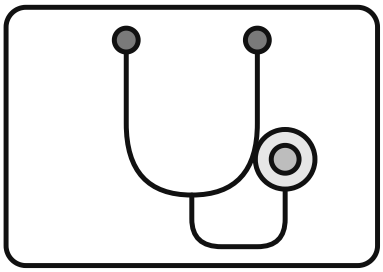
There are two parts: **A** and **B**.
Your teacher will play or read each part **two times**.
Listen carefully.
Before each part, you have one minute to read the questions.
You can answer while you listen, or after.

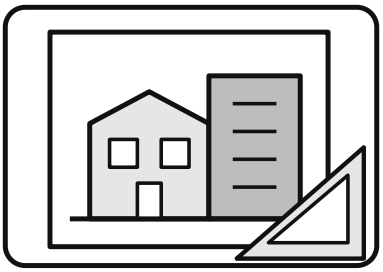
Part A

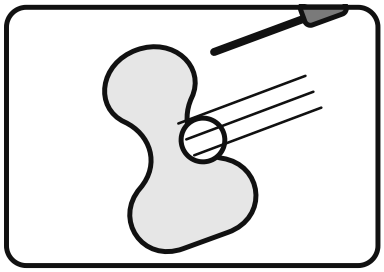
You will hear a phone conversation between **Li Na**, a school student, and her cousin **Chen Yu**, a university student. **Answer** questions 1 to 8.

1 / 1

What does Chen Yu study?
Tick one picture.


A ☐


B ☐


C ☐

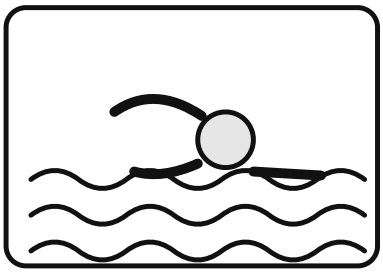
2 / 1

Where does Chen Yu live?
Tick one.

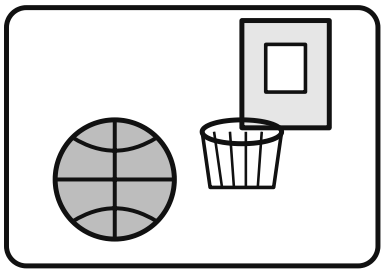
☐ in a flat ☐ in a student hall ☐ with her family

3 / 1

What does Chen Yu do on Wednesday afternoons?
Tick one picture.


A ☐


B ☐


C ☐

4 / 1

How many students are in Chen Yu's room this year, including Chen Yu? ☐

5 / 1

How long does it take Chen Yu to cycle to her classes? ☐ minutes

6 / 1

How much does Chen Yu earn an hour **now**? ¥ ☐

7 / 1

Li Na says, "I don't think I could do that."
What does she mean?

8 / 1

Why does Chen Yu tell Li Na about her three school friends?

Part B

You will hear a talk by **Dr Wang Hao**. He is an engineer who designs plants that turn seawater into drinking water.
Your teacher will play or read the talk **two times**.
You have one minute to read questions 9 to 16 first.

9 / 1

How many grams of salt are there in one litre of seawater?

[ ] grams

10 and 11 / 2

Complete the notes. **Write** one to three words in each gap.

Example: Osmosis is the natural movement of water through a very thin skin called a [**membrane**].

Notes: turning seawater into drinking water

10 Sand filters remove sand, seaweed and tiny living things that would [ ] the membranes.

11 At the end, [ ] are added back, because completely pure water tastes flat.

12 / 1

The plant has four stages.
Write 1, 2, 3 and 4 to show the order of the stages. 1 is the **first** stage.

[ ] Push the water through membranes at high pressure.

[ ] Pump seawater in through a pipe on the sea floor.

[ ] Add minerals and a little chlorine.

[ ] Remove sand and tiny living things.

13 / 1

How many cubic metres of drinking water does the plant produce each day **now**?

[ ] cubic metres

14 / 1

Dr Wang says the brine must be released "slowly and far out" from the shore.
Use the talk to **explain** why.

15 / 1

Some people say that a coastal city with a desalination plant never needs to worry about water again.
What does Dr Wang think about this? **Tick** one.

- ☐ He agrees, because the sea will never run out.
- ☐ He thinks cities should stop wasting water through leaking pipes first.
- ☐ He thinks desalination is too dangerous for the coast and should stop.
- ☐ He thinks only engineers should decide about water.

16 / 1

What is the main purpose of Dr Wang's talk? **Tick** one.

- ☐ To persuade the audience that desalination plants should be closed.
- ☐ To explain how seawater is made drinkable and to weigh the benefits against the costs.
- ☐ To advertise the plant that his team built.
- ☐ To report that the city's pipes are leaking.

Reading

There are two parts: **A** and **B**.

Part B is harder than Part A.

Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.

You have 15 minutes. When you finish, wait for your teacher.

Part A

Read the web page. Then **answer** questions 1 to 7.

harboursummeracademy.example/courses

Harbour Summer Academy

Two-week courses for students aged 16 to 18

Dates

Session 1: 6 to 17 July

Session 2: 20 to 31 July

Courses and fees

Course	Where	Fee
Engineering Design	University campus	¥6 800
Creative Writing	City library	¥4 500
Marine Biology	Coastal field centre	¥7 200
Debating and Public Speaking	University campus	¥4 500

Fees include lunch and all materials. Accommodation (a shared room) costs ¥2 400 extra for students who do not live in the city.

How to apply

1 Complete the online form.

2 Upload a letter from a teacher.

3 Pay a deposit of ¥500 by 15 May.

Places are limited to 20 on each course.

Scholarships

Ten full scholarships for students whose families cannot pay the fee.

Write 300 words on why you want **to attend. Deadline: 30 April.**

Note Students on the Marine Biology course must be able to swim 50 metres.

Questions? Email: hello@harboursummeracademy.example

1 / 1

On which dates is Session 2? _____

2 / 1

How much does the Creative Writing course cost? ____

3 / 2

Tick the **two** courses that take place at the university campus.

- ☐ Engineering Design
- ☐ Creative Writing
- ☐ Marine Biology
- ☐ Debating and Public Speaking

4 / 1

Sofia lives in another city. She wants to do the Marine Biology course and stay in the shared accommodation.

How much will she pay in total? ¥ ____

5 / 1

What must you upload with the online form? ____

6 / 1

Wang Hao cannot swim. Which course can he **not** choose?

____

7 / 1

Tom wants a scholarship. What must he write, and by what date?

____

Part B

Read the article. Then **answer** questions 8 to 14.

Lost, and Better for It

By Lin Xiaoyu

Last spring, in a city I had never visited, my phone died at four o'clock on a Saturday afternoon. I remember the moment precisely, because of what followed: a cold, almost childish panic. I was standing on an ordinary street, in daylight, surrounded by people, and I had no idea which way to turn. The blue dot that had guided me for a decade had vanished, and with it, apparently, went my sense of direction, my memory of the route and my nerve.

It took me a moment to realise how absurd this was. I am an adult. I can read. The city had street signs, a river, a cathedral tower visible above the rooftops and several thousand residents who knew exactly where the station was. Yet my first instinct was not to look up at the tower but down at the dead screen, as if staring at it hard enough might bring it back to life.

Navigation apps are, I admit, a marvel. They have ended the misery of the folded paper map that could never be refolded, and the arguments in the front seats of cars. They have made unfamiliar cities feel safe for lone travellers, and they have saved a good many of us from missed trains. I am not about to suggest that anyone delete them. What I want to question is the habit of using them for every journey, including the ones we have made fifty times before.

Here is what I notice. When I follow the blue line, I arrive, but I arrive knowing nothing. I could not tell you what I passed. The city shrinks to a corridor: a screen, a pavement and a destination. The phone is a patient, tireless servant, and like all servants who do everything for us, it leaves us quietly incapable.

This is not merely a romantic complaint. Researchers who study how we find our way distinguish between following a route (turn left, then second right) and building a mental map of a place. The second skill is slower and harder, and it is the one that fades when we never use it. A study I read about last year asked two groups of volunteers to learn a new part of a city, one group with an app and one with a paper map and their own eyes. A week later, the map group could still sketch the area; the app group could barely recall the name of the street where they had started. I did not find this surprising. Nobody remembers a journey they did not have to pay attention to.

There is also the small matter of other people. On that Saturday afternoon, after several minutes of staring at a blank screen, I finally did what my grandmother would have done in the first thirty seconds: I asked someone. An elderly man with a shopping bag not only pointed me towards the station but walked me to the corner, told me which bakery to visit and which to avoid, and wished me a good journey in a dialect I only half understood. It was

the best conversation I had all weekend. Every app-guided journey I have ever made has been a journey in which I spoke to no one.

I can hear the objection. Getting lost is a luxury; most of us are simply trying to get to work on time, and nobody wants to be late for an interview because they fancied a little adventure. Fair enough. I am not asking anyone to be lost when it matters. I am suggesting something far more modest: that on the journeys that do not matter, the walk to a friend's house, the Sunday wander, the trip to a shop three streets away, we leave the phone in our pocket and find out whether we still can.

Since that afternoon I have followed a rule. In a new city, I allow myself the app for the first day. After that, I navigate by tower, river and the kindness of strangers, and I accept that I will sometimes end up in the wrong place. I have ended up in some excellent wrong places. I have also, for the first time in years, started to see the cities I visit as places rather than as routes.

My phone, charged again, still knows the way. I am simply trying to make sure that I do too.

8 / 1

In the first paragraph, the writer says that her "sense of direction", her "memory of the route" and her "nerve" vanished with the blue dot.
Using your own words, explain what she lost when her phone died.

9 / 1

What does "absurd" mean in "how absurd this was"? **Tick** one.

☐ dangerous ☐ ridiculous ☐ unlucky ☐ exciting

10 / 1

"Yet my first instinct was not to look up at the tower but down at the dead screen."
What does this sentence tell you about the writer's habits?

11 / 1

How does the writer feel about her meeting with the elderly man?
Give one piece of evidence from the text.

12 / 1

The writer calls the phone "a patient, tireless servant".
What does this comparison suggest about the phone, and why is it effective?

13 / 1

Which statement best describes the writer's view of navigation apps? **Tick** one.

- ☐ Everyone should delete them.
- ☐ They are useful, but we should sometimes find our own way.
- ☐ Paper maps are always better than apps.
- ☐ Getting lost is always a good thing.

14 / 2

Using your own words, give **two** reasons the writer gives for not using the app on every journey.

Reason 1

Reason 2

Writing

Choose one task: A or B.

Tick the box for the task you choose.

Plan your ideas in the plan box. Then **write** on the lines.

You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can.

Task A: a story ☐

Write a story that ends with the words:

> … and for the first time, I was glad I had stayed.

Ideas: who is telling the story, where they are, why they wanted to leave, what changed their mind.

Task B: an essay ☐

Some people say:

> Exam results are the only fair way to choose students for university.

Do you agree? **Write** an essay for a student magazine. Give your opinion, with reasons and examples.

Include at least one argument **against** your view, and explain why you do not accept it.

Plan

Notes and ideas (this part is not marked)

Your writing

Task A ☐ Task B ☐

Maths

You have 25 minutes. Do as much as you can.

Write your answer in the box. **Show** your working in the working box.

Your teacher can read any question to you.

Sections A and B: you may **not** use a calculator.

Section C: you **may** use a scientific calculator.

Section A: Fluency

No calculator

What the maths words and symbols mean

In the form $a + b\sqrt{5}$: write the answer like $2 + 3\sqrt{5}$, where a and b are whole numbers.

Surd form: keep the square root in your answer, for example $\sqrt{12} = 2\sqrt{3}$.

f(x) = 2x + 1 means "double x, then add 1". So f(3) = 7. **gf(x)** means "do f first, then do g".

$f^{-1}(x)$ is the **inverse** of f: it undoes f.

$\frac{dy}{dx}$ is the **gradient function** (the derivative). If $y = x^n$, then $\frac{dy}{dx} = nx^{n-1}$. Example: $y = x^2 + 4x$ gives $\frac{dy}{dx} = 2x + 4$.

A column vector $\begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$ means 3 across and 1 down. **|a|** is the **length** (magnitude) of the vector **a**.

1 / 1

Expand and simplify $(\sqrt{5} + 1)(\sqrt{5} - 2)$. **Give** your answer in the form $a + b\sqrt{5}$.

2 / 1

Solve $3^{2x-1} = 81$ $x =$

3 / 2

$f(x) = \frac{x - 3}{2}$ $g(x) = x^2 + 1$

(a) **Work out** gf(7).

(b) **Find** $f^{-1}(x)$. $f^{-1}(x) =$

4 / 2

$y = x^3 - 6x^2 + 5x$

(a) **Find** $\frac{dy}{dx}$. $\frac{dy}{dx} =$

(b) **Work out** the gradient of the curve at the point where $x = 2$.

5 / 2

$\mathbf{a} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$ $\mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$

(a) **Write** $2\mathbf{a} - \mathbf{b}$ as a column vector.

(b) **Work out** $|\mathbf{a} + \mathbf{b}|$. **Give** your answer in surd form.

6 / 2

(a) **Write** $x^2 - 8x + 3$ in the form $(x - a)^2 - b$.

(b) **Hence solve** $x^2 - 8x + 3 = 0$. **Give** your answers in surd form.

$x =$ or $x =$

Section B: Word questions

No calculator

The questions in this section are in words only.
Read each question carefully. Decide what to do.

Write an equation, then solve it.
Three consecutive numbers add up to 87. Find the numbers.
(Consecutive numbers come one after another, like 5, 6 and 7.)

Let the smallest number be n. The numbers are n, $n + 1$ and $n + 2$.
Equation: $n + (n + 1) + (n + 2) = 87$
Solve: $3n + 3 = 87$, so $3n = 84$, so $n = 28$.
Answer: the numbers are 28, 29 and 30.

7 / 2

Mei saves money every week.
In the first week she saves ¥20. Each week she saves ¥6 more than the week before.
So she saves ¥20, then ¥26, then ¥32, and so on.

(a) In which week does she **first** save more than ¥100? Week ☐

(b) **Work out** the total amount she has saved after 12 weeks.

Working

¥ ☐

8 / 2

The brightness of light from a lamp is **inversely proportional to the square** of the distance from the lamp.
At a distance of 2 metres, the brightness is 90 units.
Work out the brightness at a distance of 3 metres.

Working

☐ units

9 / 2

Two numbers add up to 9.
The sum of their squares is 53.
Write an equation in one unknown, then **solve** it.
Find the two numbers.

Working

and

10 / 2

Jun cycles 12 km from home to school at a steady speed.
If he cycled 3 km/h faster, the journey would take 12 minutes less.
Write an equation, then **solve** it.
Find Jun's usual speed.

Working

km/h

Section C: Applied problems

You may use a scientific calculator

Show your working. You can get marks for your working, even if your answer is wrong.

11

/ 2

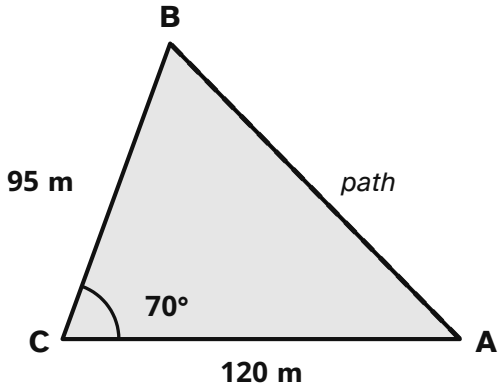
A field is a triangle ABC.
CA = 120 m, CB = 95 m and angle ACB = 70°.
A straight path is to be built from A to B.

Work out the length of the path.
Give your answer to 3 significant figures.

Working

m

Not drawn accurately



12

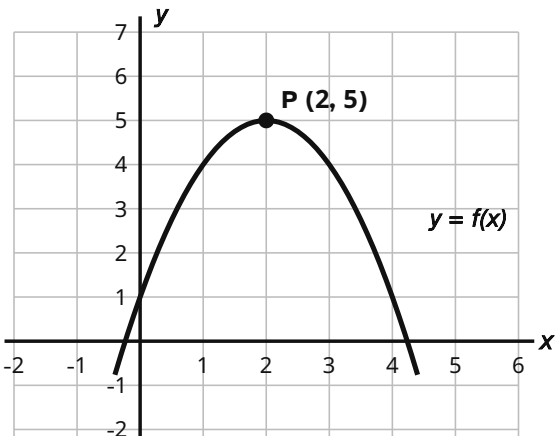
/ 2

The diagram shows the graph of $y = f(x)$.
The maximum point of the curve is P (2, 5).

Write the coordinates of the maximum point of each of these graphs.

(a) $y = f(x) + 3$ (,)

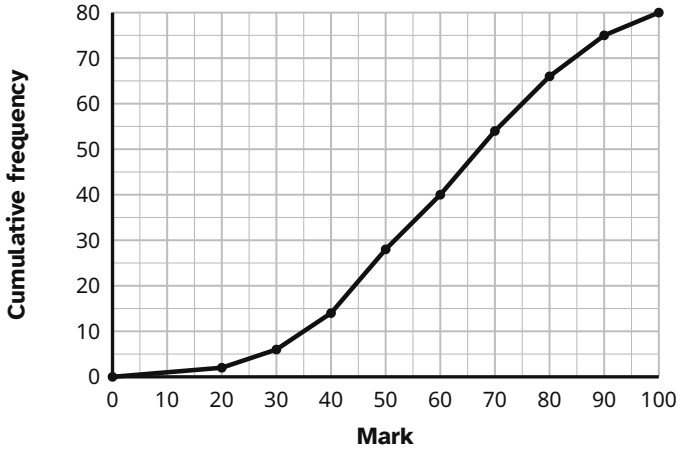
(b) $y = f(x + 1)$ (,)



13

/ 2

80 students took a test. The cumulative frequency graph shows their marks.



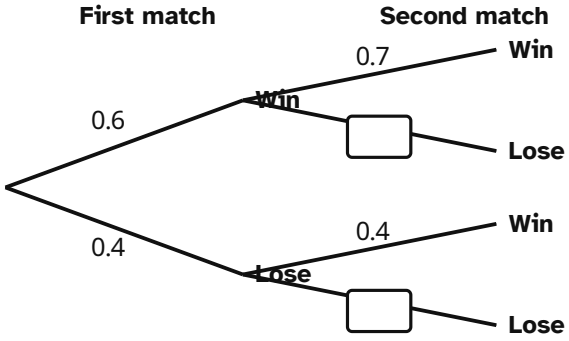
(a) **Find** the median mark.

(b) **Work out** the interquartile range.

14

/ 2

Mei plays two matches in a table tennis competition.
The probability that she wins the first match is 0.6.
If she wins the first match, the probability that she wins the second is 0.7.
If she loses the first match, the probability that she wins the second is 0.4.



(a) **Complete** the tree diagram.

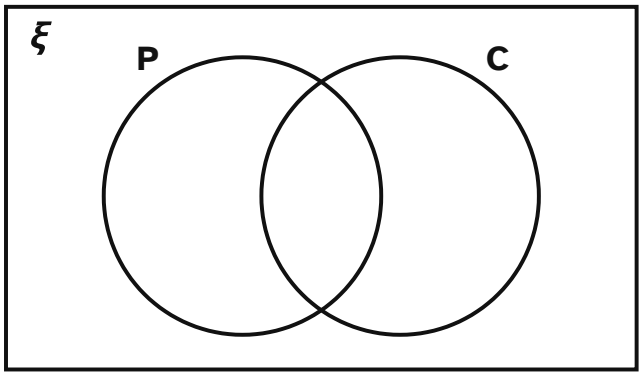
(b) **Work out** the probability that Mei wins **exactly one** of the two matches.

Working

15

/ 2

There are 40 students in a year group.
24 study Physics (P). 18 study Chemistry (C).
6 study neither.



(a) **Complete** the Venn diagram.

$n(P \cap C) =$ ☐

(b) A student is chosen at random.
Work out the probability that the student studies **exactly one** of the two subjects.

☐

16

/ 2

The population of a town is 48 000.
The population grows by 2.5% every year.
The town council says: "The population will pass 60 000 within 8 years."
Is the council right? **Show** how you decide. You can use the table.

Year	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Population	48 000	49 200							

Working

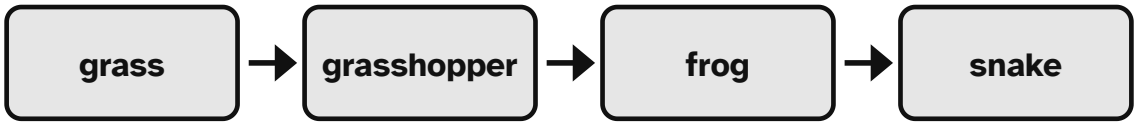
Tick one. Yes, the council is right. ☐ No, the council is wrong. ☐

Science

You have 8 minutes. Do as much as you can.
Your teacher can read any question to you.

1 / 1

This is a food chain.

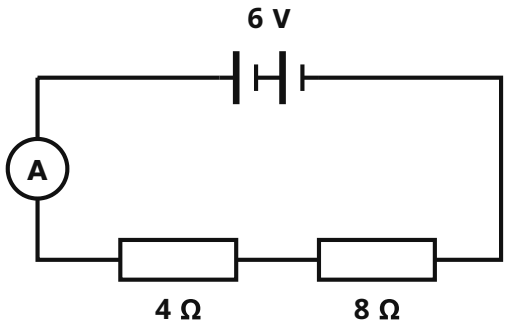


The arrows show the direction of energy flow.

Which organism is the **secondary consumer**? **Write** its name. ☐

2 / 2

The diagram shows a circuit.



(a) **Work out** the total resistance of the circuit.

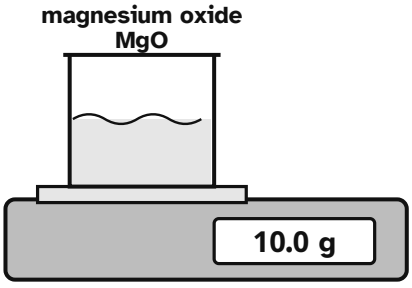
☐ Ω

(b) **Work out** the reading on the ammeter.
Use: $V = I \times R$.

☐ A

3 / 1

The beaker holds 10.0 g of magnesium oxide, MgO.
Relative atomic masses: Mg = 24, O = 16.

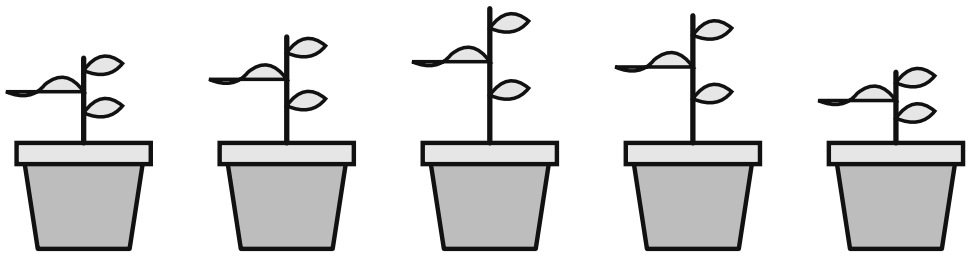


Work out the number of moles of magnesium oxide in the beaker.
Use: moles = mass ÷ relative formula mass.

☐ mol

4 / 3

Aisha investigates how fertiliser affects plant growth. She grows one plant in each pot and waters each pot with a different concentration of fertiliser. After 4 weeks she measures the height of each plant.



Fertiliser (grams per litre of water)	0	1	2	3	4
Height of plant after 4 weeks (cm)	12	15	19	18	10

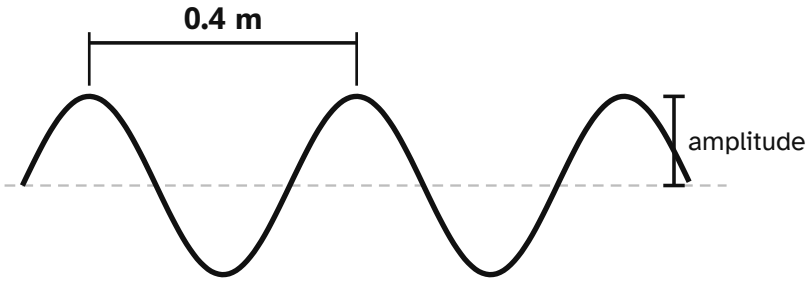
(a) **Describe** the pattern in the results.

(b) **Write** one variable Aisha must keep the same.

(c) Aisha grew only one plant at each concentration. **Suggest** one way to improve her method.

5 / 1

The diagram shows a wave. Its frequency is 50 Hz.



Work out the speed of the wave. Use: wave speed = frequency × wavelength.

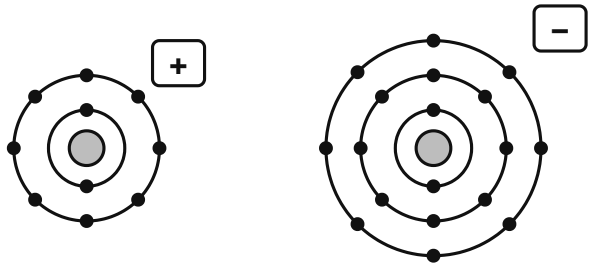
[ ] m/s

6

/ 1

Sodium chloride is made of these ions.
Solid sodium chloride does **not** conduct electricity.
Molten (melted) sodium chloride **does** conduct electricity.

Explain why.



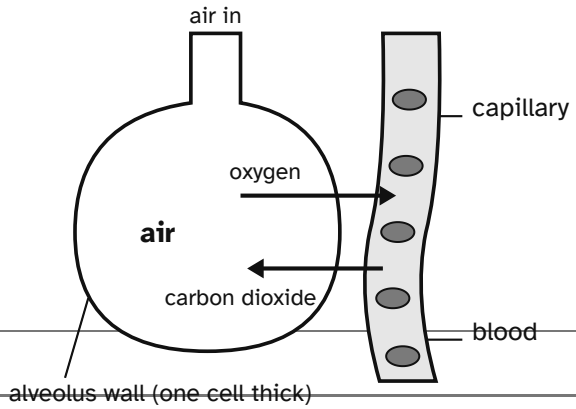
sodium ion, Na^+ **chloride ion, Cl^-**

7

/ 1

The diagram shows an alveolus in the lung.

Write one feature of the alveolus that makes gas exchange fast, and say **why** it helps.



Thank you. You have finished this paper. Please wait for your teacher.

Year 12 grading sheet (version 3.1)

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Date of birth		**Current school**	
Date of assessment		**Assessor**	

Paper version sat: v3.1 (on the front page of the student paper). **For staff only.** Mark the student paper first (every question has a mark box; answers and mark schemes are in `Y12_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`). Copy the totals here and give the bands from the guide below. The optional sciences are marked with `Y12_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1` and the cognitive screen with `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide`. Reading is recorded on the **Reading front sheet** and speaking on the **Interview sheet**.

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening (Part A / 8, Part B / 8)	A ___ + B ___ = ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	Part B not given? ☐
Writing (four criteria, each / 4)	content ___ vocabulary ___ grammar ___ spelling and punctuation ___ = ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	Task chosen: A B Counter-argument answered? ☐
Maths (Fluency / 10, Word questions / 8, Applied / 12)	F ___ + W ___ + A ___ = ___ / 30	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	NT: L:
Core science (/ 10)	___ / 10	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	NT: L:
Optional Biology (/ 15)	___ / 15	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	Not taken ☐ NT: L:
Optional Chemistry (/ 15)	___ / 15	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	Not taken ☐ NT: L:
Optional Physics (/ 15)	___ / 15	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	Not taken ☐ NT: L:
Cognitive ability screen (raw scores; not banded, never used to select)	Non-verbal ___ / 12 Quantitative ___ / 12 Verbal ___ / 12 Processing speed ___ / 60		Extra time given? ☐ Profile note:
Reading	Reading front sheet		
Speaking	Interview sheet		

Maths profile. Fluency ___ % · Word questions ___ % · Applied ___ %.

☐ Fluency much higher than word questions: was the barrier English? (A word question solved after it was read aloud or given in Chinese.)

☐ Fluency and word questions much higher than applied: needs teaching in problem solving, reading graphs and explaining.

Second visit. Parts taken on a second day (optional sciences, interview): _____ Date: _____

Not yet taught (NT) topics, and the likely maths and science bands once taught:

Access arrangements (extra time, reader, breaks) and **behaviour and wellbeing** during the assessment:

Assessor's comment (strengths, English barrier or not, the cognitive profile and what support the student would need, anything to follow up):

Assessor signature and date _____

Readiness for A Level (Section 6 of `Y12_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`; read the results together first)

Decision	Tick one in each row
English course	☐ English as a Second Language support ☐ First Language level ☐ To decide
A Level Maths	☐ Suitable ☐ With support ☐ Not advised ☐ To decide
Sciences	☐ Suitable for the A Level sciences taken ☐ With support ☐ Not advised
Readiness	☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Pre-A Level year advised ☐ Not yet
Support	☐ English of maths ☐ Academic writing ☐ Content gaps ☐ Extra time to check ☐ None

Band guide at a glance (full guide and judgement notes: `Y12_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`)

Band	Listening (/ 16)	Writing (/ 16; best fit decides)	Maths (/ 30)	Core science (/ 10)	Each optional science (/ 15)
A or **1**	Part A 0 to 2	0 to 3	1 Below expected: 0 to 10	1: 0 to 3	1: 0 to 4
B or **2**	Part A 3 to 4	4 to 7	2 Working towards: 11 to 16	2: 4 to 5	2: 5 to 7
C or **3**	Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	8 to 10	3 Expected: 17 to 22	3: 6 to 8	3: 8 to 11
D or **4**	Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	11 to 13	4 Greater depth: 23 to 30	4: 9 to 10	4: 12 to 15
E	Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	14 to 16			

Cognitive screen profile (guide, Section on reading the profile): non-verbal and quantitative both 9 or more with verbal low usually means strong reasoning and an English gap; processing speed well below the other parts suggests checking reading fluency and extra time; all three reasoning parts 4 or less suggests discussing further assessment before a decision. Raw scores only: the screen is not standardised.

Cognitive Ability Screen

Years 11 and 12. Version 3.1, October 2026

Name	
Date	

Welcome

This is not a test you can pass or fail.
It helps us plan how to support your learning.
There are four short parts. Each part is timed.
Your teacher will tell you when to start and when to stop each part.
Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets them all right.
If you are not sure, choose the answer you think is best and go on.

How to answer

Most questions have five answers, **A**, **B**, **C**, **D** and **E**.

Write the letter of your answer in the box. **B**

Some questions ask for a number.

Write the number in the box. **20**

If you change your mind, cross out your first answer and write the new one.

The parts

Part	What you do	Time
1 Non-verbal reasoning	Patterns made of shapes. 12 questions.	8 minutes
2 Quantitative reasoning	Patterns made of numbers. 12 questions.	8 minutes
3 Verbal reasoning	Patterns made of words. 12 questions.	6 minutes
4 Processing speed	Write the number for each symbol, as fast as you can.	90 seconds

You need a pencil and a rubber. You may **not** use a calculator.
Your teacher can read the instructions to you again in English.
Do not turn the page until your teacher tells you to.

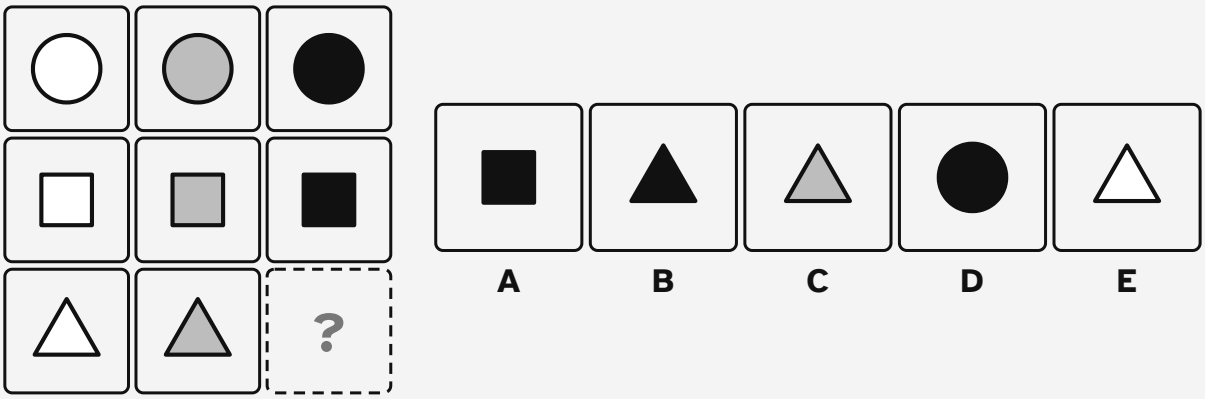
Part 1: Non-verbal reasoning

You have **8 minutes**. There are 12 questions.

Each question shows a pattern made of shapes. One figure is missing.

Choose the figure from **A** to **E** that fits the pattern. **Write** the letter in the box.

Example. Which figure goes in the empty cell?



Each row has one shape. Across each row, the colour goes white, grey, black.

So the missing figure is a **black triangle**. The answer is **B**. B

There are three kinds of question:

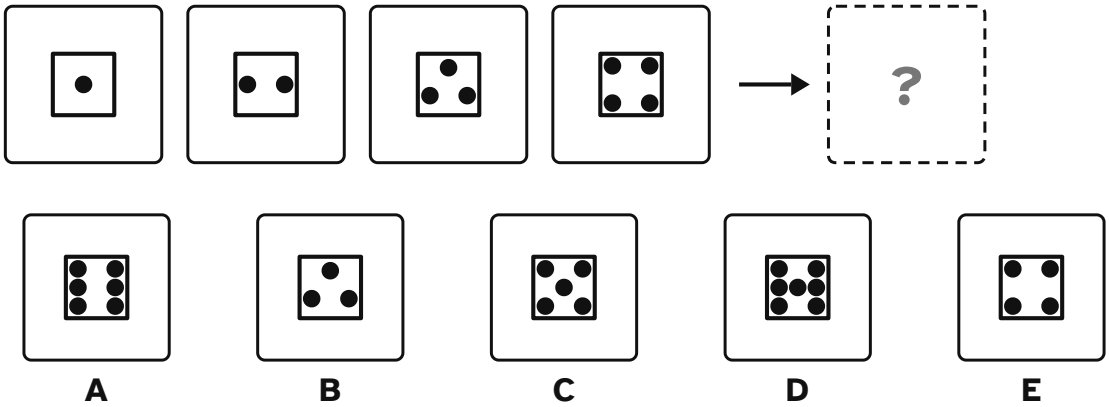
Which figure goes in the empty cell? Look across the rows and down the columns.

Which figure comes next? Look at how the figures change from left to right.

Which figure is the odd one out? Four figures follow the same rule. One does not.

1 / 1

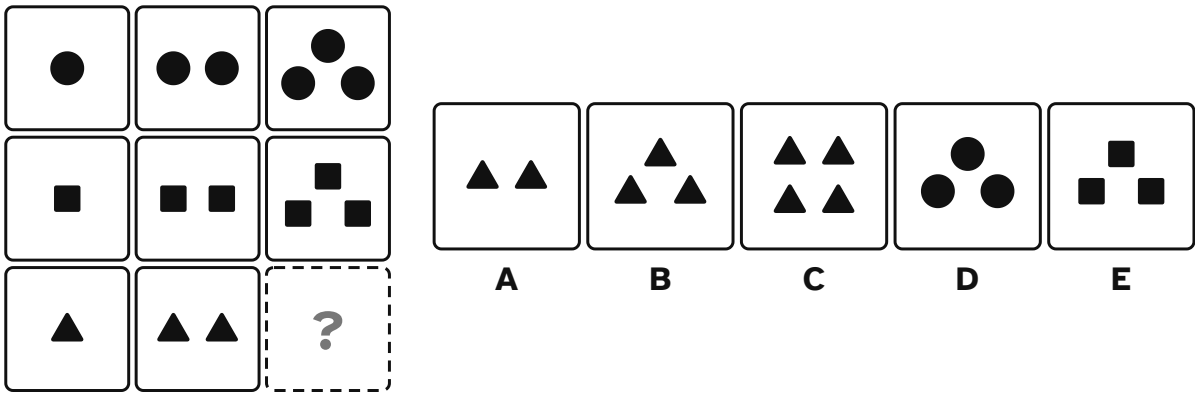
Which figure comes next?



Write the letter. ____

2 / 1

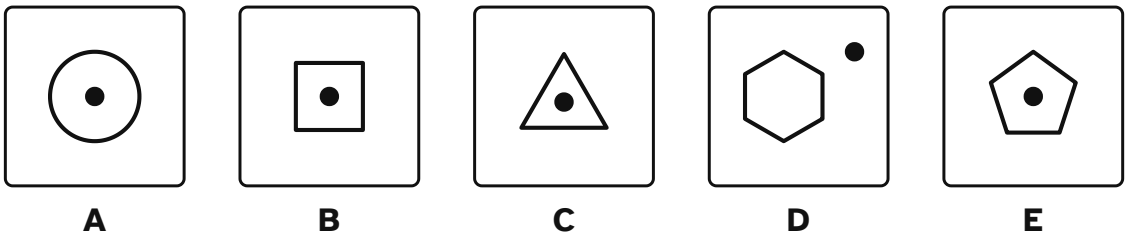
Which figure goes in the empty cell?



Write the letter. ☐

3 / 1

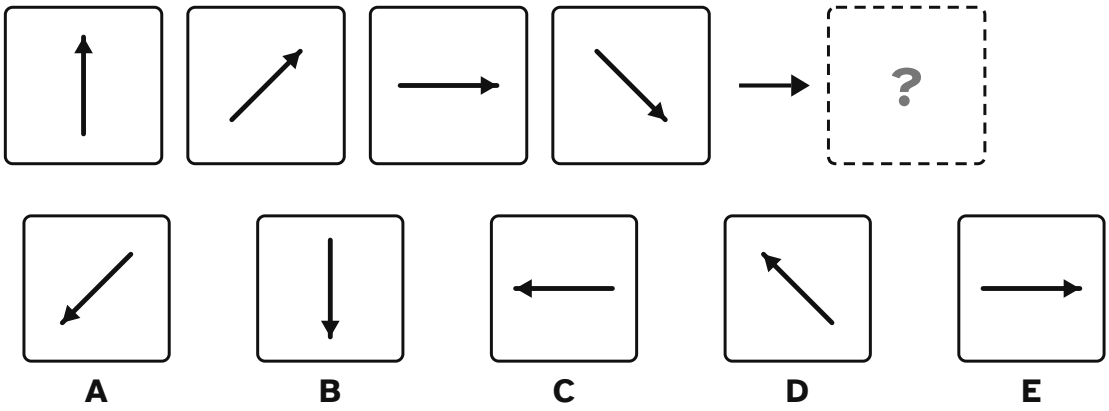
Which figure is the odd one out?



Write the letter. ☐

4 / 1

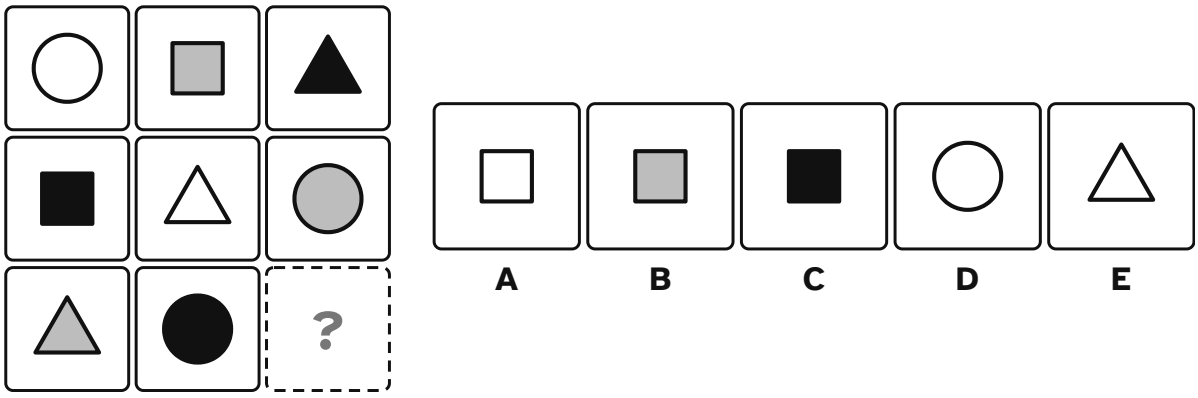
Which figure comes next?



Write the letter. ☐

5 / 1

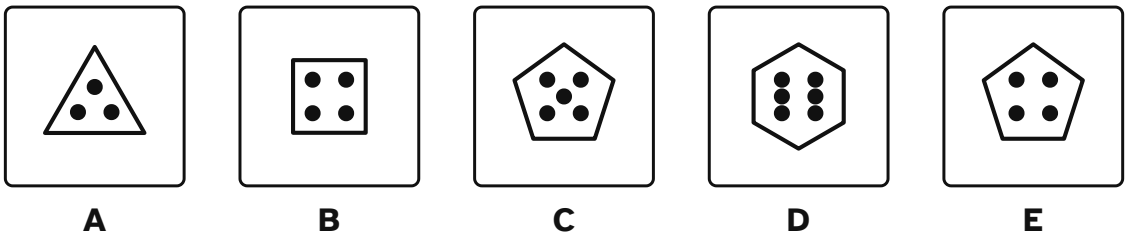
Which figure goes in the empty cell?



Write the letter. ____

6 / 1

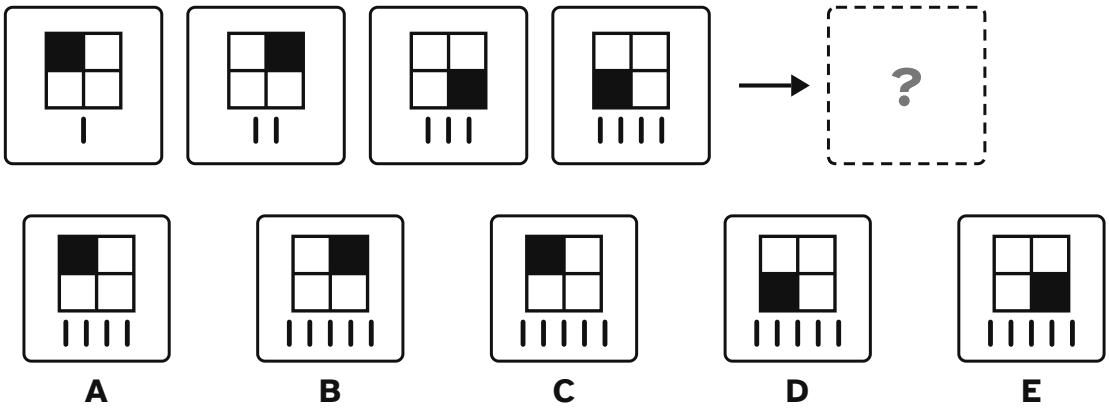
Which figure is the odd one out?



Write the letter. ____

7 / 1

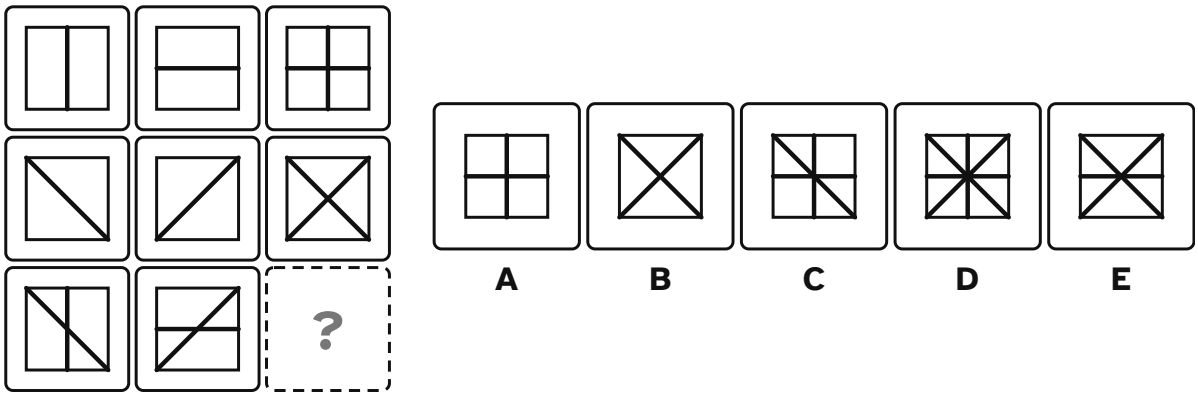
Which figure comes next?



Write the letter. ____

8 / 1

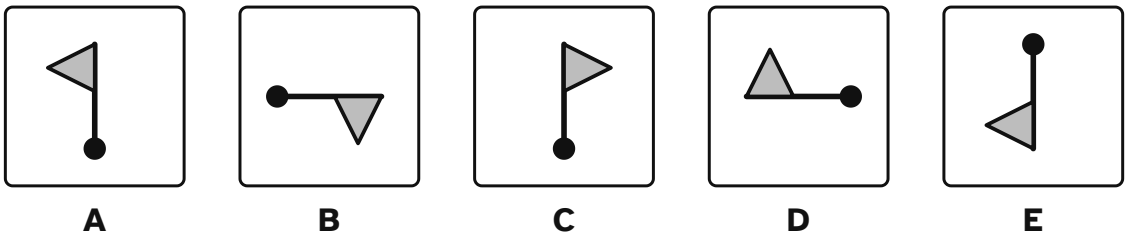
Which figure goes in the empty cell?



Write the letter. ____

9 / 1

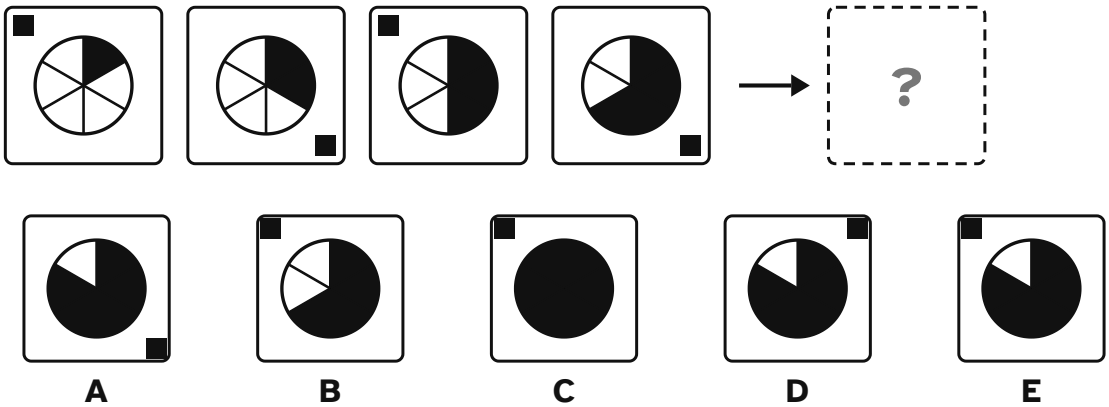
Which figure is the odd one out?



Write the letter. ____

10 / 1

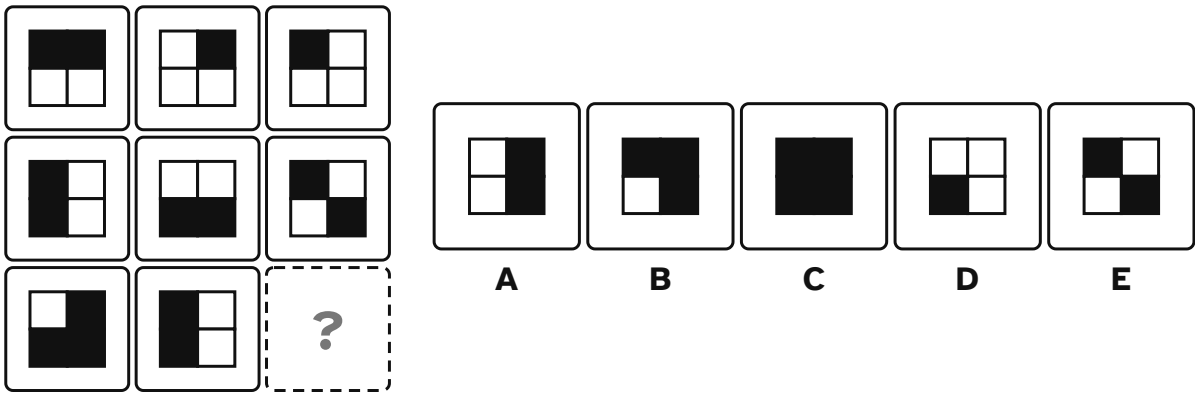
Which figure comes next?



Write the letter. ____

11 / 1

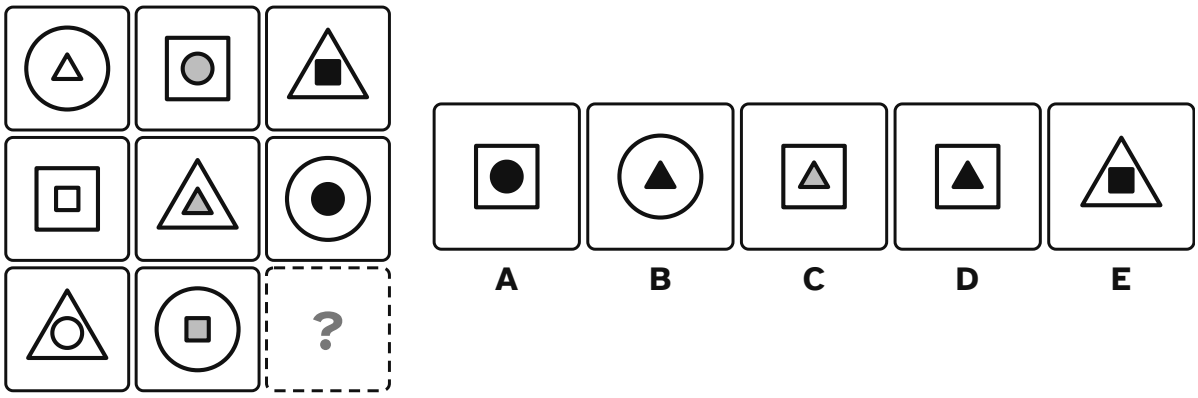
Which figure goes in the empty cell?



Write the letter. ____

12 / 1

Which figure goes in the empty cell?



Write the letter. ____

Stop. Wait for your teacher.

Part 2: Quantitative reasoning

You have **8 minutes**. There are 12 questions. **No calculator.**
Each question shows a pattern made of numbers. **Find** the rule. Then **write** the missing number, or the letter, in the box.

Example 1. Which number comes next? **3, 6, 9, 12, ?**

The numbers go up by 3 each time. The next number is **15**. **15**

Example 2. Which number is missing? **2 : 6** **4 : 12** **5 : ?**

In each pair, the second number is 3 times the first. 5 × 3 = 15. **15**

Example 3. Which number is missing? Each row follows the same rule.

1	**2**	**3**
4	**1**	**5**
2	**6**	**?**

In each row, the first two numbers add to make the third. 2 + 6 = 8. **8**

1 / 1

Which number comes next?

4, 8, 12, 16, ?

Write the number. ☐

2 / 1

Which number comes next?

50, 45, 40, 35, ?

Write the number. ☐

3 / 1

Which number is missing? The rule is the same in every pair.

6 : 3 **8 : 4** **10 : ?**

Write the number. ☐

4 / 1

Which number is missing? Each row follows the same rule.

3	**4**	**7**
6	**2**	**8**
5	**4**	**?**

Write the number. ☐

5 / 1

Which number comes next?

1, 2, 4, 8, 16, ?

Write the number. ☐

6 / 1

Which is the **largest**?

A $\frac{1}{2}$ **B** 0.6 **C** $\frac{3}{5}$ **D** 0.55 **E** $\frac{2}{3}$

Write the letter. ☐

7 / 1

Which number comes next?

2, 3, 5, 8, 12, ?

Write the number. ☐

8 / 1

Which number is missing? The rule is the same in every pair.

4 : 7 **10 : 19** **7 : ?**

Write the number. ☐

9 / 1

Which number is missing? Each row follows the same rule.

2	3	6
4	5	20
3	7	?

Write the number. ☐

10 / 1

Each shape stands for a number. The same shape is always the same number.

● + ● + ▲ = 14 ● + ▲ = 9 ▲ = ?

Write the number. ☐

11 / 1

Which number comes next?

3, 4, 8, 9, 18, 19, ?

Write the number. ☐

12 / 1

Which number is missing? The rule is the same in every pair.

3 : 10 **5 : 26** **7 : ?**

Write the number. ☐

Stop. Wait for your teacher.

Part 3: Verbal reasoning

You have **6 minutes**. There are 12 questions.
Each question is about words. **Choose** the best answer from **A** to **E**. **Write** the letter in the box.

Example 1. Day is to night as up is to ... ?

A down **B** high **C** sky **D** light **E** morning

Day and night are opposites. The opposite of up is **down**. **A**

Example 2. Which word is the odd one out?

A red **B** blue **C** green **D** cold **E** yellow

Four words are colours. **Cold** is not a colour. **D**

Example 3. Mei is taller than Jun. Jun is taller than Tom. Who is the tallest?

A Jun **B** Tom **C** Mei **D** They are the same **E** Cannot tell

Mei is taller than Jun, and Jun is taller than Tom. So **Mei** is the tallest. **C**

1 / 1

Hot is to cold as big is to ... ?

A tall **B** small **C** long **D** high **E** heavy

Write the letter. ☐

2 / 1

Which word is the odd one out?

A apple **B** orange **C** chair **D** banana **E** lemon

Write the letter. ☐

3 / 1

Bird is to fly as fish is to ... ?

A swim **B** water **C** sea **D** walk **E** eat

Write the letter. ☐

4 / 1

Li Na is older than Tom. Tom is older than Mei. Who is the youngest?

A Li Na **B** Tom **C** Mei **D** They are the same age **E** Cannot tell

Write the letter. ☐

5 / 1

Which word is the odd one out?

A happy **B** sad **C** angry **D** tall **E** afraid

Write the letter. ☐

6 / 1

Shoe is to foot as hat is to … ?

A hair **B** hand **C** coat **D** cold **E** head

Write the letter. ☐

7 / 1

All the students in Class 4 play football. Wang Hao is in Class 4.
Which sentence **must** be true?

A Wang Hao plays football. **B** Wang Hao likes football.

C Everyone who plays football is in Class 4. **D** Wang Hao plays football well.

E Wang Hao does not play basketball.

Write the letter. ☐

8 / 1

Which word is the odd one out?

A minute **B** hour **C** week **D** clock **E** year

Write the letter. ☐

9 / 1

Begin is to end as ask is to … ?

A question **B** answer **C** say **D** tell **E** speak

Write the letter. ☐

10 / 1

Three friends sit in a row. Sofia sits on the left of Amir. Jun sits on the right of Amir.
Who sits in the middle?

A Sofia **B** Amir **C** Jun **D** Nobody **E** Cannot tell

Write the letter. ☐

11 / 1

Always is to never as everything is to ... ?

A nothing **B** something **C** everyone **D** anything **E** all

Write the letter. ☐

12 / 1

If it rains, the game stops. The game did not stop.
Which sentence **must** be true?

A It rained. **B** The game was long. **C** It will rain tomorrow. **D** Cannot tell.

E It did not rain.

Write the letter. ☐

Stop. Wait for your teacher.

Part 4: Processing speed

In this part you have **90 seconds**. Work as **fast** as you can, but try not to make mistakes.
The key shows nine symbols. Each symbol has a number.

Key

○	△	□	+	×	◇	—	∨	T
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

Under each symbol there is an empty box. **Look** at the key. **Write** the number for that symbol in the box.
Go from **left to right** along each row. Do **not** skip any boxes.

Example. The circle is 1 in the key, so you write 1. The plus is 4 in the key, so you write 4.

○	+
1	4

Practice

Write the number for each symbol in these six boxes now. Use the key above. This practice is not timed.

□	○	◇	T	△	—

Your teacher will check your practice row with you.

Stop. Wait for your teacher to say "Start".

Now the timed task

Write the number for each symbol. Go from left to right along each row, then start the next row. When your teacher says **"Stop"**, put your pencil down at once.

Key	○	△	□	+	×	◊	−	V	T
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

△	T	V	T	□	V	−	×	◊	+	×	T

V	◊	+	○	△	V	×	−	+	−	+	T

V	◊	□	○	◊	○	−	□	−	△	−	×

◊	□	×	+	T	△	○	□	◊	×	△	−

+	T	○	T	□	×	V	◊	V	○	△	□

Stop. Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.

Year 12 Admission Assessment: Optional sciences

Version 3.1, October 2026

Name	
Date	

Welcome

These questions show us what you already know in science. They help us plan your A Level courses.

Do your best. It is fine if you cannot answer every question.

If you have not learnt a topic, tell your teacher and go on to the next question.

Do only the sciences your teacher tells you to do. Tick the sciences you are doing today:

Biology ☐ Chemistry ☐ Physics ☐

How to answer

Tick one box.

Which one is a gas at room temperature? iron ☐ oxygen ☑ water ☐

Write your answer in the box. Give the unit if the question asks for it.

Mass of 2 litres of water: **2 kg**

Show your working. You can get marks for your working, even if your answer is wrong.

Working

speed = 100 ÷ 20 = 5 m/s

Explain means: say what happens **and** why. Use scientific words.

The parts of this paper

Part	What you do	Time
Biology	7 questions, 15 marks	15 minutes
Chemistry	8 questions, 15 marks	15 minutes
Physics	7 questions, 15 marks. The equations you need are printed in a box.	15 minutes

You may use a pencil, a rubber, a ruler and a **scientific calculator** in all three sciences.

Your teacher can read any question to you in English. Write all your answers in English.

Stop at the end of each science and wait for your teacher.

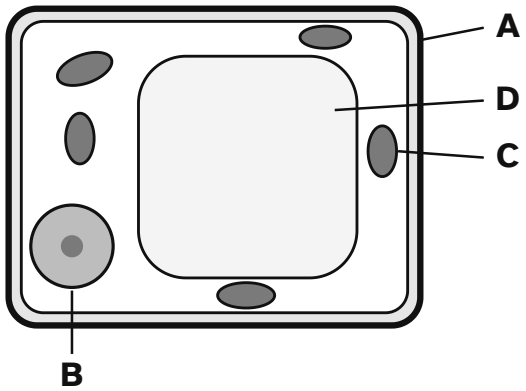
Biology

You may use a scientific calculator

You have 15 minutes. Do as much as you can.
Your teacher can read any question to you.

1 / 1

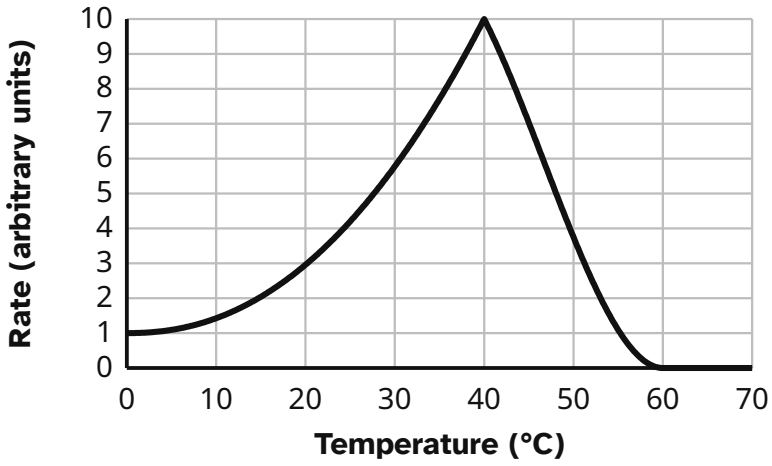
This is a plant cell.



Which letter shows the part where photosynthesis happens? **Write** the letter. ____

2 / 2

The graph shows how temperature affects the rate of a reaction controlled by an enzyme.



(a) **Write** the optimum temperature of this enzyme. ____ °C

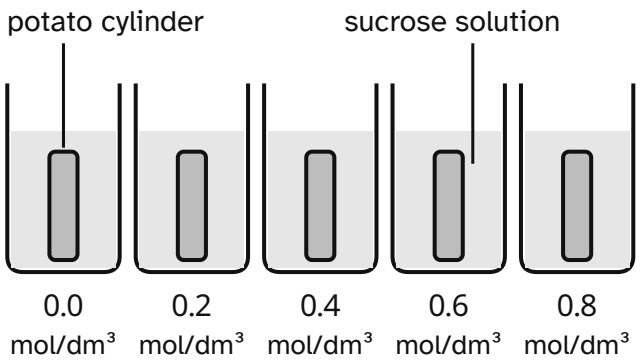
(b) At 60 °C the rate is zero. **Write** the scientific word for what has happened to the enzyme.

____

3

/ 3

Mei cuts five potato cylinders of the same size and mass.
She puts each one in a different sucrose solution for one hour.
Then she measures the change in mass.



Concentration of sucrose solution (mol/dm³)	0.0	0.2	0.4	0.6	0.8
Change in mass (%)	+8	+3	0	–4	–9

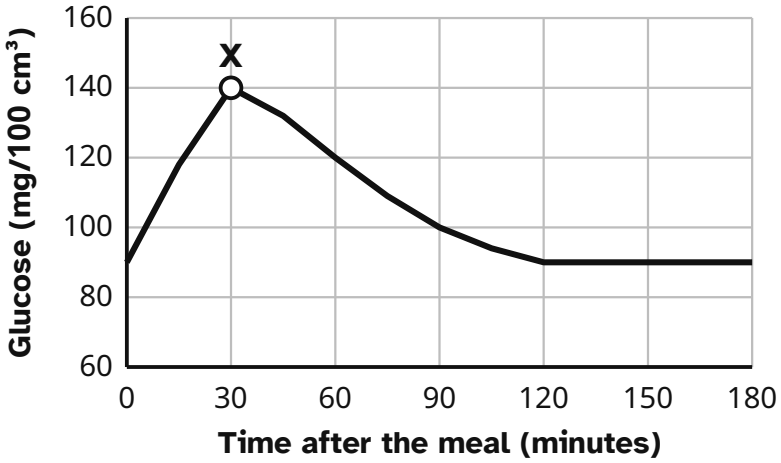
(a) Which concentration of sucrose solution has the same concentration as the contents of the potato cells? ☐ mol/dm³

(b) **Explain** why the potato cylinder in the 0.8 mol/dm³ solution lost mass.

4

/ 1

The graph shows the glucose concentration in a person's blood after a meal.



At point X the pancreas releases a hormone. This hormone makes the blood glucose concentration fall.

Write the name of the hormone. ☐

5

/ 3

In pea plants, the allele for purple flowers (**P**) is dominant.
The allele for white flowers (**p**) is recessive.
Two plants with the genotype **Pp** are crossed.

(a) **Complete** the Punnett square to show the genotypes of the offspring.

gametes from parent 1

gametes from parent 2	**P**	**p**
P	**PP**	
p		

(b) What percentage of the offspring are expected to have white flowers?

[ ] %

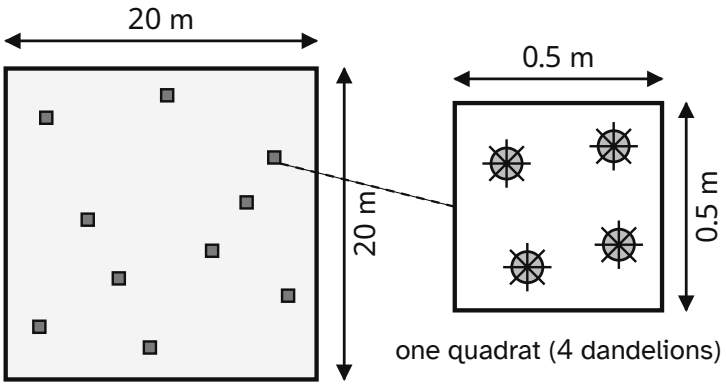
(c) **Write** the expected ratio of purple-flowered plants to white-flowered plants.

[ ] : [ ]

6

/ 3

Li Na estimates the number of dandelion plants in a square field 20 m by 20 m. She places a quadrat 0.5 m by 0.5 m (area 0.25 m²) at 10 random positions and counts the dandelions inside it each time.



Quadrat	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**9**	**10**
Number of dandelions	3	5	2	4	6	3	4	5	2	6

(a) **Work out** an estimate of the total number of dandelion plants in the field. **Show** your working.

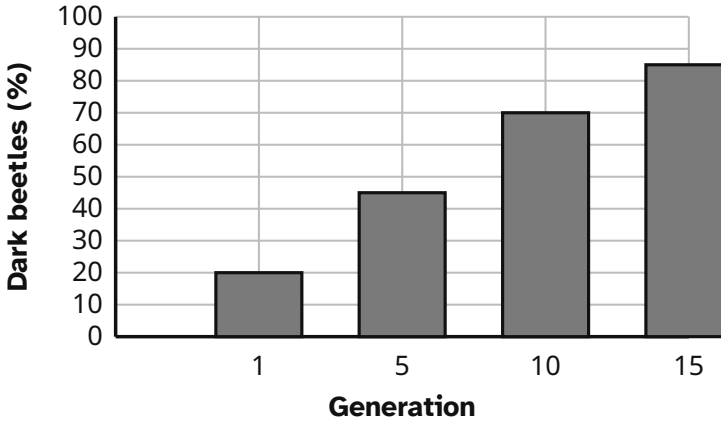
Working

[ ] dandelion plants

(b) **Explain** why Li Na placed the quadrat at random positions.

7 / 2

A population of beetles lives on dark soil. Some beetles are light brown and some are dark brown. Birds eat the beetles. The chart shows how the percentage of dark beetles in the population changed over 15 generations.



Explain how natural selection caused this change.

Stop. That is the end of Biology. Wait for your teacher.

Chemistry

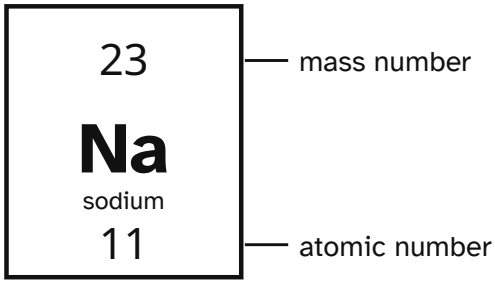
You may use a scientific calculator

You have 15 minutes. Do as much as you can.
Your teacher can read any question to you.
Relative atomic masses: H 1, C 12, O 16, Na 23, Cl 35.5, Ca 40.

1 / 1

This is the box for sodium from the periodic table.

How many **neutrons** are there in one atom of sodium?



2 / 2

The table shows some properties of three substances, X, Y and Z.

Substance	Melting point (°C)	Conducts electricity when solid?	Conducts electricity when molten?
X	801	no	yes
Y	−182	no	no
Z	3550	no	no

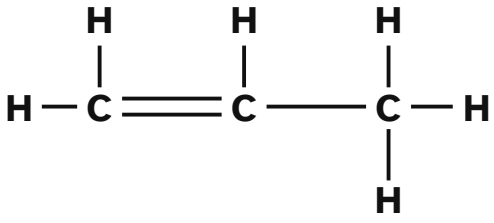
(a) Which substance is an ionic compound? **Write** the letter.

(b) **Explain** why this substance conducts electricity when it is molten but not when it is solid.

3 / 1

This is the displayed formula of a hydrocarbon.

Write the name of the homologous series it belongs to.



4 / 3

When calcium carbonate is heated strongly, it decomposes:

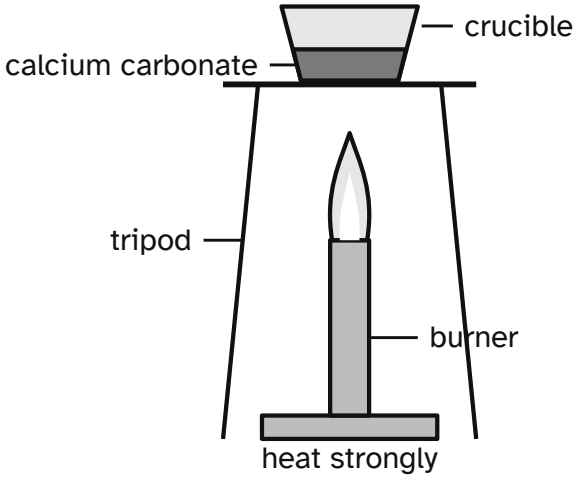
$CaCO_3 \rightarrow CaO + CO_2$

Amir heats 25.0 g of calcium carbonate until it has all decomposed.

Work out the mass of calcium oxide (CaO) made. **Show** your working.

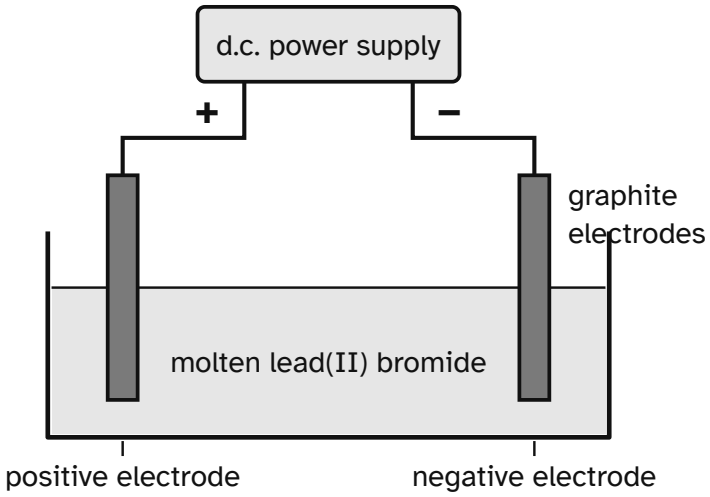
Working

g



5 / 1

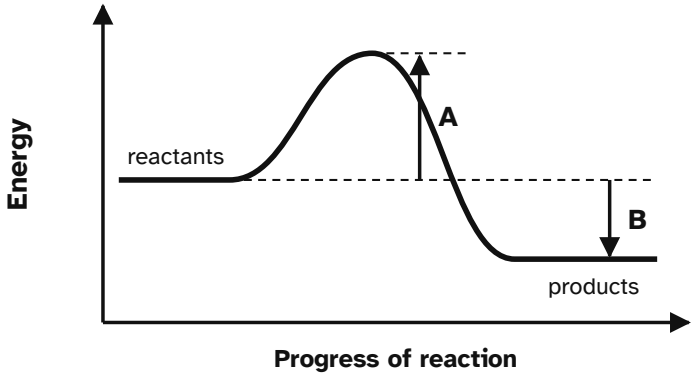
Molten lead(II) bromide is electrolysed using graphite electrodes.



Write the name of the product formed at the **negative** electrode.

6 / 1

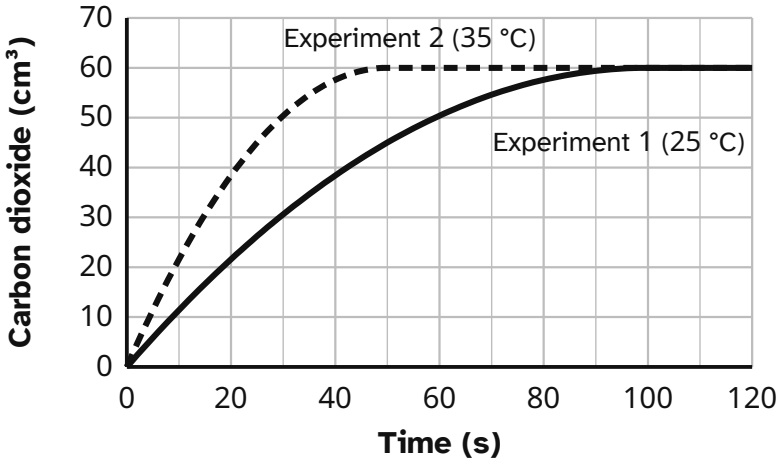
This is the reaction profile for a chemical reaction.



Which arrow, **A** or **B**, shows the activation energy? **Write** the letter. ☐

7 / 3

Chen Yu adds marble chips (calcium carbonate) to dilute hydrochloric acid and collects the carbon dioxide. She does the experiment twice: experiment 1 at 25 °C and experiment 2 at 35 °C. She uses the same mass of marble chips and the same volume and concentration of acid each time.



(a) How long does experiment 1 take to finish? ☐ s

(b) **Explain**, in terms of particles, why the reaction is faster at 35 °C.

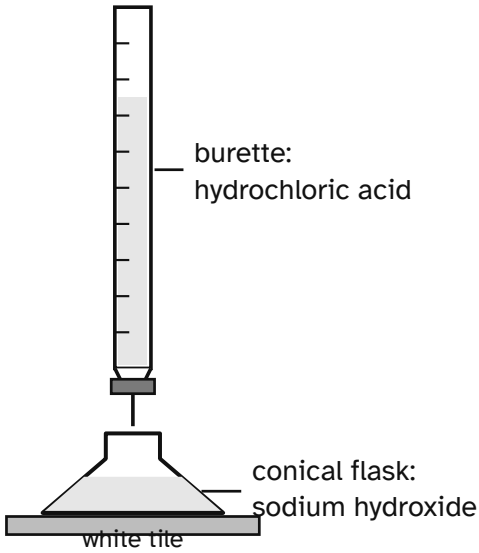
8 / 3

Wang Hao puts 25.0 cm^3 of sodium hydroxide solution in a conical flask.
He titrates it with hydrochloric acid of concentration 0.100 mol/dm^3.

$NaOH + HCl \rightarrow NaCl + H_2O$

His results:

Titration	**rough**	**1**	**2**	**3**
Volume of acid (cm^3)	20.60	20.05	19.95	20.40



(a) Which **two** titrations should he use to find the mean volume? ☐ and ☐

(b) The mean volume of acid is 20.00 cm^3. **Work out** the concentration of the sodium hydroxide solution in mol/dm^3. **Show** your working.

Working

☐ mol/dm^3

Stop. That is the end of Chemistry. Wait for your teacher.

Physics

You may use a scientific calculator

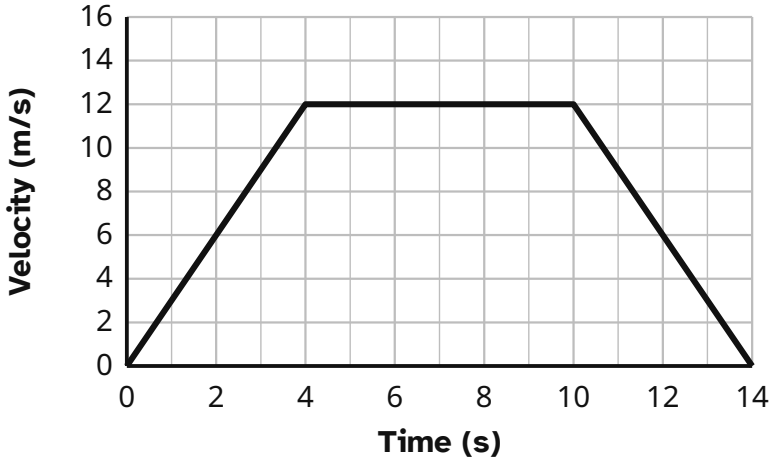
You have 15 minutes. Do as much as you can.
Your teacher can read any question to you.

Equations you may need

average speed = distance ÷ time	voltage = current × resistance
acceleration = change in velocity ÷ time taken	electrical power = voltage × current
force = mass × acceleration	charge = current × time
weight = mass × g (g = 10 N/kg)	resistors in series: $R = R_1 + R_2$
momentum = mass × velocity	transformer: $V_p \div V_s = N_p \div N_s$ (p primary, s secondary)
work done = force × distance	pressure = force ÷ area
gravitational potential energy = mass × g × height	density = mass ÷ volume
kinetic energy = ½ × mass × speed^2	wave speed = frequency × wavelength
power = energy transferred ÷ time	efficiency = useful energy out ÷ total energy in

1 / 1

The graph shows the velocity of a car during 14 seconds.

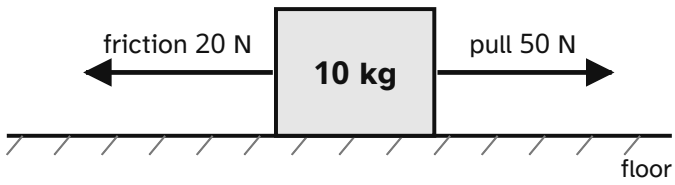


Work out the acceleration of the car during the first 4 seconds.

_____ m/s^2

2 / 2

Sofia pulls a box of mass 10 kg along the floor with a force of 50 N. The friction force is 20 N.

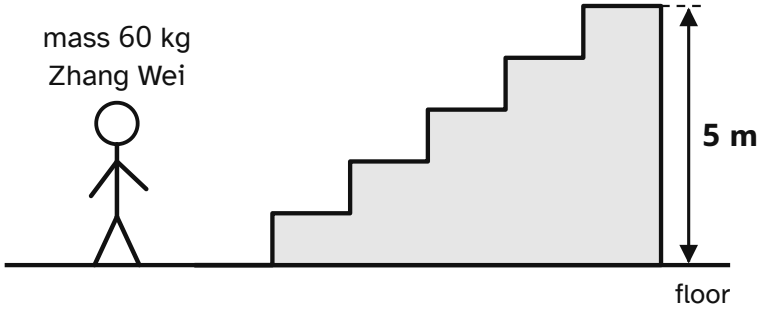


(a) **Work out** the resultant force on the box. ☐ N

(b) **Work out** the acceleration of the box. ☐ m/s^2

3 / 2

Zhang Wei has a mass of 60 kg. He climbs a staircase 5 m high in 10 seconds.

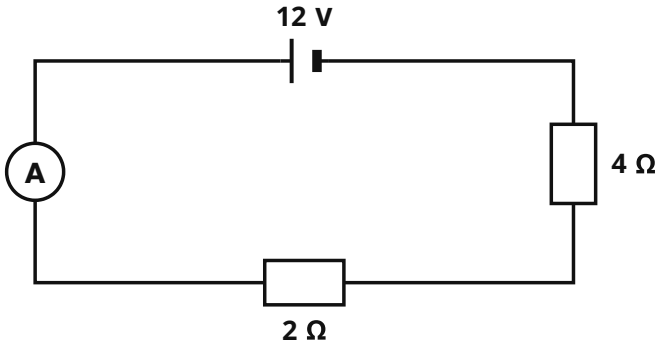


(a) **Work out** the gravitational potential energy he gains. ☐ J

(b) **Work out** his average power while climbing. ☐ W

4 / 2

A 12 V battery is connected to two resistors in series, as shown.



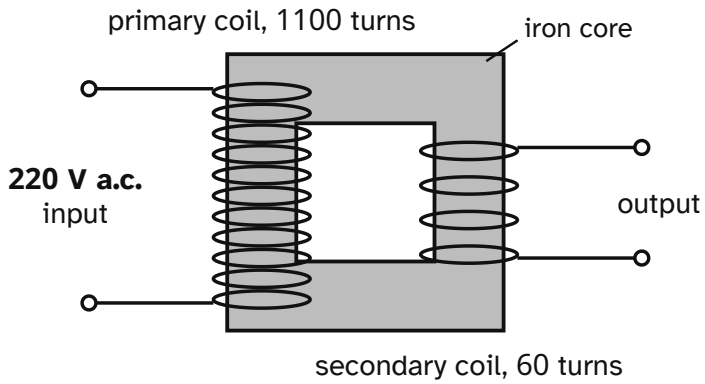
(a) **Work out** the total resistance of the circuit. ☐ Ω

(b) **Work out** the reading on the ammeter. ☐ A

5

/ 3

The diagram shows a transformer.



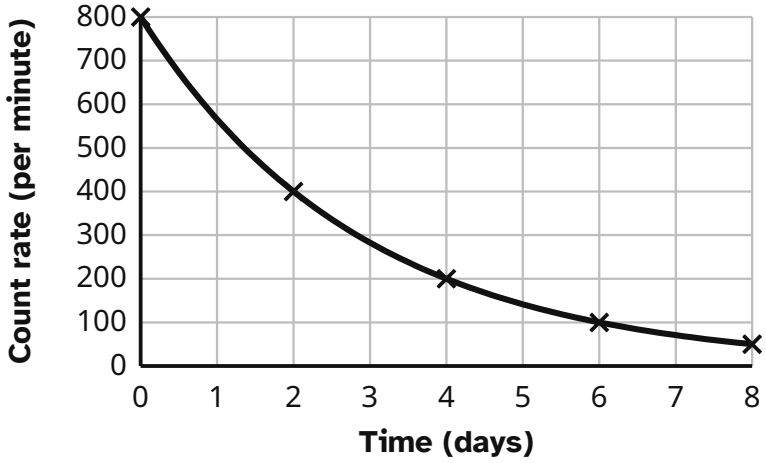
(a) **Work out** the output voltage. ☐ V

(b) **Explain** why the transformer does not work if the input is d.c. (direct current).

6

/ 2

Tom measures the count rate of a radioactive source for 8 days. The count rates have been corrected for background radiation.



(a) Use the graph to find the half-life of the source. ☐ days

(b) Before he put the source in place, Tom measured the count rate with no source present. **Explain** why.

7 / 3

Trolley A has a mass of 2 kg and moves at 3 m/s towards trolley B. Trolley B has a mass of 1 kg and is at rest. The trolleys stick together when they collide.



(a) **Work out** the momentum of trolley A before the collision. ____ kg m/s

(b) **Work out** the velocity of the two trolleys after the collision. **Show** your working.

Working

____ m/s

Stop. That is the end of Physics. Thank you. Wait for your teacher.

Reading front sheet: reading levels and sentence reading

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date of birth**	
Age today (years:months)		**Date**	

For staff only. One sheet for each candidate, all year groups. The assessor fills in Part 1 and gives this sheet to the interviewer (usually the principal) before the interview. The interviewer, or in Years 1 to 3 the assessor, runs the sentence reading with `Sentence_Reading_Guide` and records it in Part 2. Part 3 gives the reading result for the final mark sheet.

1. Reading levels so far (the assessor fills this in)

Item	Details
Handed over by, and time	Handed over by _____ at _____ Received by _____
Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen (its Sheet 13)	Letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 Phonics words ___ / 40 Tricky words ___ / 20 Book band _____ (Oxford Level ___) Accuracy ___ % Questions ___ / ___
Years 4 to 6: reading paper	Part A ___ / 8 Part B ___ / 8 Part C ___ / 8 Total ___ / 24
Years 7 to 12: reading paper	Part A ___ / 8 Part B ___ / 8 Total ___ / 16 Stopped at 15 minutes at question ___
Reading band so far	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D ☐ E
Sentence reading starts at	☐ the level for the year group (table below) ☐ Level 1, because the student is new to English
Tell the interviewer	(for example: shy, needs more time, stopped early, anxious about English)

Year group	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Start at level (first sentence)	1 (1)	1 (1)	2 (4)	3 (7)	4 (10)	5 (13)	6 (16)	7 (19)	8 (22)	9 (25)	9 (25)	9 (25)

2. Sentence reading (Graded Sentence Reading Screen)

Run by: ☐ interviewer ☐ assessor (Years 1 to 3, after the Early Reading Screen). Write 2, 1 or 0 for each sentence (none, one, two or more errors), then the meaning check and the level total. **Levels below the start level:** write 6 in the total if the student scored 6 out of 6 on the start level (guide, Section 1). **Stop** at the end of a level with 2 points or fewer, after three 0s in a row, or if the student is upset.

Level	Sentence a	Sentence b	Sentence c	Meaning check	Level total
1 (sentences 1 to 3)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
2 (4 to 6)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
3 (7 to 9)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
4 (10 to 12)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
5 (13 to 15)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
6 (16 to 18)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
7 (19 to 21)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
8 (22 to 24)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
9 (25 to 27)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
10 (28 to 30)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
11 (31 to 33)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
12 (34 to 36)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6

Errors, what the student said when you are not sure, and **patterns noticed** (S substitution, O omission, I insertion, T told; SC self-correction is not an error). Patterns such as missing -ed or -s endings, or pinyin letter values, are useful evidence:

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3. Result (copy to the final mark sheet)

Measure	Result
Total points (including 6 for each level below the start level that was not read)	___ / 72
Reading age (5:00 plus 2 months for every point: 6 points = 6:00, 12 = 7:00, 30 = 10:00, 60 = 15:00, 72 = 17:00)	_____ : _____
Actual age (years:months) and difference (reading age minus actual age)	Actual _____ : _____ Difference _____ months
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	___ asked, ___ ✓
Fluency on the last level read with 4 or more points (1 word by word, 2 two or three words, 3 sensible phrases, 4 smooth)	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4
Indicative reading band from the sentence reading (table below)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Reading band for the final mark sheet (the Early Reading Screen in Years 1 to 3, the reading paper in Years 4 to 12; if it differs from the sentence reading by more than one band, say why)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Band from the reading age (the full guide and the notes are in `Sentence_Reading_Guide`)

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 12	Band
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below	up to 12 months below	**E**
Below	7 to 12 months below	13 to 24 months below	**D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below	25 to 42 months below	**C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below	43 to 60 months below	**B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below	more than 60 months below	**A**

Years 1 and 2: use the reading age as supporting evidence only. If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one (decoding ahead of understanding).

Interview sheet: Years 11 and 12

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date**	
Interviewer		**Others present**	

Questions and descriptors: `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y11_Y12`. Sentence reading is recorded on the Reading front sheet. For staff only.

Speaking and listening

Speaking band: ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Listening in conversation (how much of your English they understood): ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand):

Key things the student said (their own words, and how they said it)

Suitability

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Strand	Rating	Evidence (a short quotation or what you saw)
Attitude to learning and resilience	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence and self-management	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Values and conduct	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for English-medium learning	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Clarity and ownership of future plans	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independent study and readiness for post-16 work	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Boarding readiness (only if the student will board)	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	
Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans	☐	

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

First impressions, and what the student would need in the first weeks:

Interviewer's comment for the final mark sheet

Strengths, concerns, support:

Interviewer signature and date _____

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Final mark sheet: candidate summary and decision

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date of birth**	
Current school		**Date of assessment**	

Paper version sat: _____ (v3.1; on the front page of the student paper). Complete within two working days from the **grading sheet**, **Reading front sheet**, **Interview sheet**, parent conversation record and homeroom teacher reference. This is the one overview that the head of section reads and that goes into the admissions system. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (copy the scores)	Band
Listening	Grading sheet: ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation (Interview sheet)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Speaking	Interview sheet (and picture talk on the grading sheet, Years 1 to 3)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Reading	Reading front sheet. Years 1 to 3: book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics ___ / 40 ; letters ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 6: paper ___ / 24. Years 7 to 12: paper ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Reading aloud	Sentence reading (Reading front sheet): points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Writing	Grading sheet: ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems (Years 7 to 12: fluency) / word problems (word questions) / applied (Years 7 to 12)	Not yet taught (NT) and language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	___ / ___ ___ / ___ ___ / 12	
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4		

1 Well below expected (Years 7 to 12: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The Years 7 to 12 papers are harder, so their boundaries are lower. Strong number problems with weak word problems may be an English barrier, not a maths difficulty. Years 7 to 12: strong fluency and word questions with weak applied problems means teaching in problem solving, not more content. NT questions score 0: say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Years 10 and 11: readiness for IGCSE (grading sheet; Section 6 of the year's instructions). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet ☐ (Year 11) start in Year 10.

Years 11 and 12: optional sciences and cognitive ability screen (grading sheet). Biology ___ / 15 band ___ Chemistry ___ / 15 band ___ Physics ___ / 15 band ___ (blank if not taken). Cognitive screen: non-verbal ___ / 12 quantitative ___ / 12 verbal ___ / 12 processing speed ___ / 60. Profile note: _____ (for planning

support, never for selection). **Year 12: readiness for A Level** (Section 6 of the Year 12 instructions): ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Pre-A Level year advised ☐ Not yet.

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Interview sheet (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Comments and feedback

Assessor (from the grading sheet): strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not.

Interviewer (from the Interview sheet): what the student is like, hopes and plans, anything of concern.

Feedback for the family. Start with the child's strengths; use plain words; say what support we will give and, if no offer is made, what would change the decision.

7. Sign-off and records

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Interviewer			
Head of section			
Admissions: outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			

Papers filed together: ☐ grading sheet ☐ Reading front sheet ☐ Interview sheet ☐ parent conversation record ☐ marked student paper. Assessment result and report given with the marked papers on: _____
Entered in the admissions system: date _____ initials _____

Assessment result and report

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date of birth**	
Current school		**Date of assessment**	

Paper version sat: _____ Assessor: _____ Interviewer: _____ Report date: _____

Outcome (from the final mark sheet, confirmed by the head of section): ☐ Offer ☐ Offer with English support ☐ Offer with a learning plan ☐ Further assessment before a decision ☐ Unable to offer at this time. Year group confirmed: _____

Results

	Score	Band	What we found (a few words)
Listening	__ / __	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Speaking (interview)		☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Reading	__ / __ reading age _____	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	Book band (Years 1 to 3):
Writing	__ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Overall English		☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Maths	__ / __	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	Topics not yet taught:
Science (Years 5 to 10)	__ / __	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Strengths

What to work on

Support we recommend from the first day (English support, maths and science catch-up, where to start reading)

Next step and review date

Head of section (name, signature, date) _____

Admissions (name, signature, date) _____

The bands show where the student is now and what support will help. They are not a pass mark. The back of this sheet explains them.

About this report

This report goes with the student's marked papers. It was made from the grading sheet, the reading and interview sheets and the parent conversation. The assessment was in English only, so the English bands show how far the student's English has come, and maths and science show what the student can do when the English is not the barrier. Some topics are taught in a different order in Chinese schools: where a student has not yet been taught a topic it scores 0 and the report says so.

The English bands

Band	Listening	Speaking	Reading	Writing
A New to English	Understands little or no English; may follow a routine instruction with gesture.	Silent, or single words and memorised phrases; may use Chinese.	May know some letter names or sounds; reads few or no words.	Copies, writes their name, or writes isolated words; may write in Chinese.
B Early acquisition	Understands simple, slow questions and instructions on familiar topics, with support.	Short phrases and simple sentences about familiar things; frequent errors.	Decodes simple words and short sentences; understands very simple texts with pictures.	Short simple sentences with familiar words; frequent errors in grammar and spelling; meaning mostly clear in short pieces.
C Developing competence	Follows most everyday talk and simple explanations; misses detail and implied meaning.	Connected sentences with "because", "but", "so"; errors common but meaning usually clear; everyday vocabulary.	Reads simple texts two or more years below age level with understanding; struggles with age-level texts.	A short connected piece; some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; basic punctuation.
D Competent	Follows most classroom talk at normal pace, including some implied meaning.	Speaks at length, explains and gives examples; occasional errors.	Reads age-level texts with some difficulty in vocabulary and inference.	Organised writing with a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; varied vocabulary.
E Fluent	Understands as a fluent speaker of the same age does.	Fluent and accurate for age.	Reads age-level texts as a fluent reader of the same age does.	Writing comparable to a fluent writer of the same age.

Reading age is an indicative figure from a short reading-aloud screen: 5 years 0 months plus 2 months for every point. It is a guide, not a standardised test.

Maths and science bands compare the score with what is expected for the year group: 1 Well below expected, 2 Working towards, 3 Expected, 4 Greater depth. The papers for older students are harder, so their boundaries are lower.

If you have questions about this report, contact the admissions office.